

Vanessa Lei

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EDUCATION

University of Southern California
Master of Science, Applied Data Science

Los Angeles, CA
Jan 2023 - Dec 2024

Ohio State University
Bachelor of Science, Financial Mathematics

Columbus, OH
Aug 2018 - May 2022

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Innovation AI

Los Angeles, CA

Financial Data Analyst

Dec 2025 - recent

- Led **3-year financial planning cycle** across AI Chatbot and Data Services product lines; developed bottom-up revenue forecasts incorporating ARPU growth, gross margin improvement (45%→55%), and customer acquisition assumptions; consolidated model projected company revenue scaling from \$268K to \$1.99M with contribution margin turning positive in Year 2 and reaching \$575K by Year 3.
- Built **unit economics model** for AI Chatbot (B2B SaaS) product line, projecting CAC of \$1,833, LTV/CAC of 3.5x at 3% monthly churn, and 9.4-month payback period; identified churn as primary risk driver and modeled contribution margin breakeven at 44 customers by Month 8.
- Built **scenario and sensitivity analysis** models to evaluate new product investments, assessing payback period, margin profile, and return metrics; supported capital allocation decisions and long-term investment prioritization across 2 product lines totaling \$1.99M projected 3-year revenue.
- Analyzed **cash flow and working capital trends**, including accounts receivable, deferred revenue, and vendor payables; developed rolling forecasts to support liquidity planning and improve short-term cash management decisions.
- Performed **P&L variance analysis** across revenue, gross margin, and operating expenses; developed automated **Tableau dashboards** to track key performance indicators, reducing manual reporting time by ~40% and support monthly and quarterly executive business reviews.

Joy Of Life Corp.

Los Angeles, CA

Billing Analyst

Feb - Dec 2025

- Standardized month-end close and reconciliation workflows across Salesforce, QuickBooks, and bank statements; reduced close cycle from ~7 to 4 days while improving accuracy of revenue recognition and client payment using **VBA**.
- Automated extraction and consolidation of billing and cash receipt data from multiple source systems using **SQL**; enhanced AR visibility and reduced overdue receivables by 18% through improved tracking, reconciliation, and reporting processes.
- Built a **rolling 12-month forecast** using **cohort-level pipeline waterfall** and **milestone-based revenue recognition** across 100+ active cases; uncovered a ~\$3.2M deferred revenue gap between cash and P&L, and built a **scenario model** quantifying \$6.1M–\$14.2M revenue range to flag liquidity risk 6+ months ahead.
- Supported **quarterly budgeting** by reconciling operational drivers with financial assumptions across Sales and Operations; performed **trending analysis** to explain budget-to-actual gaps and improve predictability of revenue and expense trends.
- Performed **monthly AR aging reviews** to identify delinquent accounts and collection risks; analyzed DSO trends and partnered with billing teams to prioritize collections and strengthen cash flow forecasting processes.
- Developed **Power BI dashboards** integrating financial and operational data to track revenue, case progression, and cost drivers; enabled variance analysis and provided actionable insights to support management decision-making.

World Disaster Center

New York, NY

Financial Data Analyst

Oct 2024 -Feb2025

- Conducted monthly reconciliations and financial reviews of restricted and unrestricted fund accounts, ensuring alignment with donor compliance requirements; supported grant audits by preparing expenditure reports within **SAP HANA**.
- Partnered with cross-functional teams to analyze **actual vs. budget variances** across departments; incorporated findings into rolling forecasts and improved internal resource allocation processes to support more data-driven financial planning.
- Developed **cost analysis models** using **Excel (pivot tables, SUMIFS, XLOOKUP)** to break down spending by program type and funding source; identified efficiency gaps and supported fund reallocation decisions for future company's planning.
- Streamlined multi-donor financial reporting by standardizing expense templates with **Alteryx workflow**, automating data consolidation, and improving accuracy of quarterly submissions; reduced manual reporting errors.

Sinotek Co., Ltd.

Shanghai, CN

Data Analyst

Apr - Aug2024

- Conducted revenue segmentation and cohort-based forecasting using **Python**, analyzing customer lifetime value across segments; identified high-margin cohorts driving 8% uplift in repeat revenue and informed targeted retention strategies.
- Built **churn forecasting and revenue sensitivity models** to evaluate impact of retention initiatives; supported strategies that increased recurring revenue by 12% and reduced customer attrition risk in lower-performing product lines.
- Partnered with marketing and product teams to align financial planning with growth initiatives; integrated performance metrics into budgeting processes, improving forecast accuracy by 20% and enabling data-driven investment decisions.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Technical Skills:** Excel, SAP, Tableau, SQL, Power BI, Python, VBA, QuickBooks, Bloomberg, Microsoft Office
- Professional Skills:** Financial Modeling, Financial Planning, Budgeting, Forecasting, Scenario Analysis, Market Research, Sensitivity Analysis, Project Management, Stakeholder Analysis, Trend Analysis, Ratio Analysis